Municipal Waste Brief

Release 2026-11-11
Coverage 2026-11-04 through 2026-11-10 inclusive, America/Edmonton

Key takeaway

Canmore's draft raises 2027 spending for Solid Waste Services by 5.2% over the 2026 budget and identifies higher collected food-waste volumes as one factor in its contracted-services increase. Before the next finance discussion, ask how much of that line comes from tonnes, contract rates and expanded service. Castlegar's reported contamination charges show why invoices and processor records belong alongside collection totals when assessing the cost of organics. Canmore Finance Committee agenda, pp. 52–53 and 94 · Castlegar council highlights

Alberta

Canmore's draft links food-waste volumes to contract spending

What changed. The November 10 Finance Committee package lists continued residential food-waste expansion and completion of a circular economy and zero-waste strategy among Solid Waste Services priorities. Its draft rollup shows these budget-to-budget changes. The agenda lists the operating budgets and variance reports for information. Town of Canmore, November 10 agenda, pp. 1, 52–53 and 94

Solid Waste Services line (CAD)	2026 budget	2027 draft	Change
Total expenditures	$5,800,905	$6,104,901	+$303,996 (+5.2%)
Contracted services	$1,223,058	$1,305,650	+$82,592 (+6.8%)
Transfers and other revenue	$800,000	$1,090,000	+$290,000 (+36.3%)

Why it matters. The budget narrative identifies increased food-waste volumes as one of several drivers of the contracted-services line. It gives no dollar allocation for that driver. The narrative also attributes a separate $110,000 increase in transfers and other revenue from the 2027 draft to the 2028 draft to extended producer responsibility (EPR). These are planned amounts. The rollup leaves the funding sources for the full 2027 transfer increase unspecified. Household rates require their own fee schedule. Town of Canmore, November 10 agenda, pp. 53 and 94

Watch next. The November 12 agenda lists a verbal report for information on the Solid Waste Services operating and capital model. Ask for the forecast tonnes by stream, any change in sites or households served, the unit rates behind contractor costs, and the activities covered by producer payments. Track residential food-waste expansion, food-service generators and residential packaging EPR under their own

service definitions. Town of Canmore, November 12 agenda, item D7

Calgary reports further capping at the ECCO landfill fire

What changed. On November 10 Calgary estimated soil capping at about 98% complete, up from its October 16 estimate of 95%. The City reported that the fire remained under control and confined to the landfill, regular site operations continued, and capping and borehole monitoring would continue. City of Calgary, incident status and timeline

Why it matters and what to watch. The percentage tracks capping work. The fire remained an active incident and the update provides no basis for quantifying residual fire risk or site-wide exposure. For Banff and Canmore, use the case to test how a receiving facility would report available capacity, load restrictions and escalation contacts during a prolonged incident. Follow the City's subsequent incident status for suppression progress and confirmation of closure. City of Calgary, incident status

Jasper staff propose more detailed biosolids planning

What changed. For the November 10 Committee of the Whole meeting, staff recommended developing implementation plans for landfill burial, modular low-temperature heat-pump drying, and land application at reclamation and mine sites. The agenda package records a staff recommendation and preliminary option screening. The committee’s direction remains to be confirmed. Municipality of Jasper, agenda item 7.1 and consultant presentation

Why it matters and what to watch. Mountain communities evaluating wastewater biosolids should document storage needs, transport distance, wet and dry tonnes, and receiving-site availability before comparing lifetime costs. Track the committee's recorded direction and later feasibility work. Jasper's options concern wastewater biosolids, a separate stream from food scraps and yard waste. Municipality of Jasper, agenda item 7.1

Lethbridge reschedules Remembrance Day collections

What changed. In its November 9 notice, the City moved regular Wednesday, November 11 curbside collection to Saturday, November 14. The Waste and Recycling Centre is scheduled to close November 11 and reopen November 12. The notice lists recycling stations and yard-waste drop-off depots as open on the holiday. City of Lethbridge service notice

Why it matters and what to watch. Match Saturday's completion records to Wednesday's scheduled routes before classifying misses or comparing daily tonnage. Retain both dates in the service log, and verify completion after Saturday. This is a scheduled holiday exception in Lethbridge. City of Lethbridge service notice

Broader Canada

Castlegar reports $24,091 in extra organics tipping fees

What changed. In council highlights published November 9, Castlegar reported $24,091 in additional tipping fees attributed to organics contamination in the first half of 2026. The City plans cart inspections and tags explaining sorting errors. The highlights also report organics at 49% of material collected and cite an initial estimate that about 40% of residential waste could be diverted to organics. The summary leaves the period and precise stream coverage for the 49% figure unspecified, so a percentage-point comparison or a diversion-rate comparison would require more detail. City of Castlegar, Curbside Collection & Organics Update

Why it matters and what to watch. A collection total alone cannot show how much was accepted by the processor. Ask for incoming organics tonnes, accepted and rejected tonnes, the invoice basis for additional charges, and the inspection launch date. If Banff or Canmore tests targeted feedback, compare contamination and surcharges per incoming tonne on the same routes and in comparable seasons, with the number of inspected carts recorded. City of Castlegar council highlights

Ottawa opens consultation on residual disposal

What changed. Ottawa opened a public survey on November 9 about landfilling and waste-to-energy incineration for the garbage remaining after reduction, recycling and composting. The City says it has secured additional landfill capacity and is still evaluating whether to pursue incineration. The first open house is scheduled for November 26 and the survey runs through December 14. City of Ottawa announcement · Engage Ottawa survey

Why it matters and what to watch. A disposal option sized against today's garbage volumes could be sensitive to future diversion and changes in who receives service. For a comparable municipal options analysis, model residual tonnes after diversion, ash disposal, haul costs and long-term contractual commitments explicitly. Watch for technical studies and a subsequent Council decision. Engage Ottawa survey

Ontario posts site-specific Dresden permit proposals

What changed. On November 6 Ontario posted proposed environmental compliance approvals or amendments covering landfill operations, transfer and processing, stormwater, and air and noise at the York1 Dresden site. The landfill amendment proposes a maximum receiving rate of 365,000 tonnes a year for non-hazardous residential and industrial, commercial and institutional waste. The notices list December 21 as the comment deadline. Ontario Environmental Registry, landfill · Transfer and processing · Stormwater · Air and noise

Why it matters and what to watch. This is a proposed receiving limit. For capacity planning, wait for final instruments and effective conditions before treating capacity as available. Keep receiving, processing, on-site storage and disposal figures in their own units and periods. The site-specific consultation is a distinct proceeding from the provincial landfill policy consultation covered in the previous Brief. Ontario Environmental Registry, landfill proposal

Practical analytics and operational actions

Decision	Record to request
Explain Canmore's contract variance	Reconcile invoices to tonnes, trips and contract rates by stream. Mark the date and service population for each site or route expansion. Report residential service per eligible household or collection point. For commercial food service, use serviced accounts and document any occupancy measure used to adjust for tourism seasonality.
Test organics feedback	Link inspection records to weigh tickets and processor invoices. Report inspected carts, incoming tonnes, accepted tonnes, rejected tonnes and incremental charges. Record any change in sorting rules or sample coverage before comparing periods.
Maintain collection and disposal continuity	Keep scheduled and completed pickups, including holiday moves, and log destination availability separately from incident milestones. Record alternative receivers, permitted streams and confirmed spare capacity before relying on them in a contingency plan.
Reconcile material flows	Keep producer-supplied quantities, collected loads, accepted inputs, recycled or composted outputs, storage and disposal separate. Account for stock movements and rejects over the same reporting period before calculating recovery.

Sources and coverage note

This targeted scan prioritizes Alberta, the Bow Valley and Canadian examples with operational implications. The linked records include draft agendas, municipal notices, a council summary, consultation material and proposed permits. Castlegar's figures are attributed to its municipal summary. Underlying weigh tickets and invoices were outside the scope of the brief. No new dated Town of Banff waste decision was verified in this scan. Canmore's November 12 item and the later consultation dates are upcoming milestones.